

Data transformation with dplyr

ds4owd - data science for openwashdata

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Sep 25, 2025

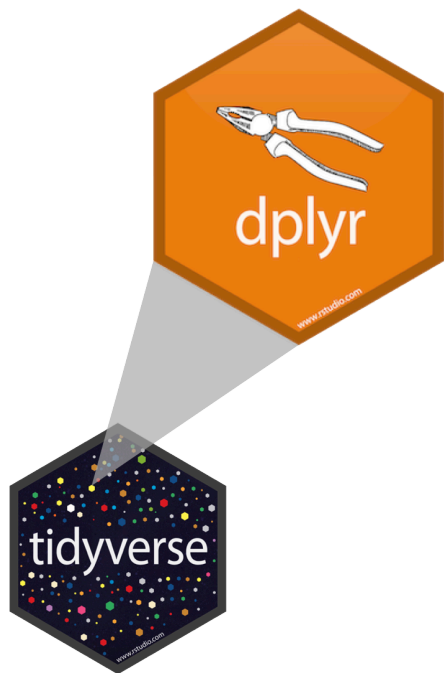
Learning Objectives (for this week)

1. Learners can apply ten functions from the dplyr R Package to generate a subset of data for use in a table or plot.

Data wrangling with dplyr

A grammar of data wrangling...

... based on the concepts of functions as verbs that manipulate data frames



- `select`: pick columns by name
- `arrange`: reorder rows
- `filter`: pick rows matching criteria
- `relocate`: changes the order of the columns
- `mutate`: add new variables
- `summarise`: reduce variables to values
- `group_by`: for grouped operations
- ... (many more)

dplyr rules

Rules of `dplyr` functions:

- First argument is always a data frame
- Subsequent arguments say what to do with that data frame
- Always return a data frame
- Don't modify in place

Functions & Arguments

```
1 library(dplyr)
2
3 filter(.data = gapminder,
4        year == 2007)
```

- Function: `filter()`
- Argument: `.data =`
- Arguments following: `year == 2007` What to do with the data

Objects

```
1 library(dplyr)
2
3 gapminder_2007 <- filter(.data = gapminder,
4                           year == 2007)
```

- Function: `filter()`
- Argument: `.data =`
- Arguments following: `year == 2007` What to do with the data
- Data (Object): `gapminder_2007`

Operators

```
1 library(dplyr)
2
3 gapminder_2007 <- gapminder |>
4   filter(year == 2007)
```

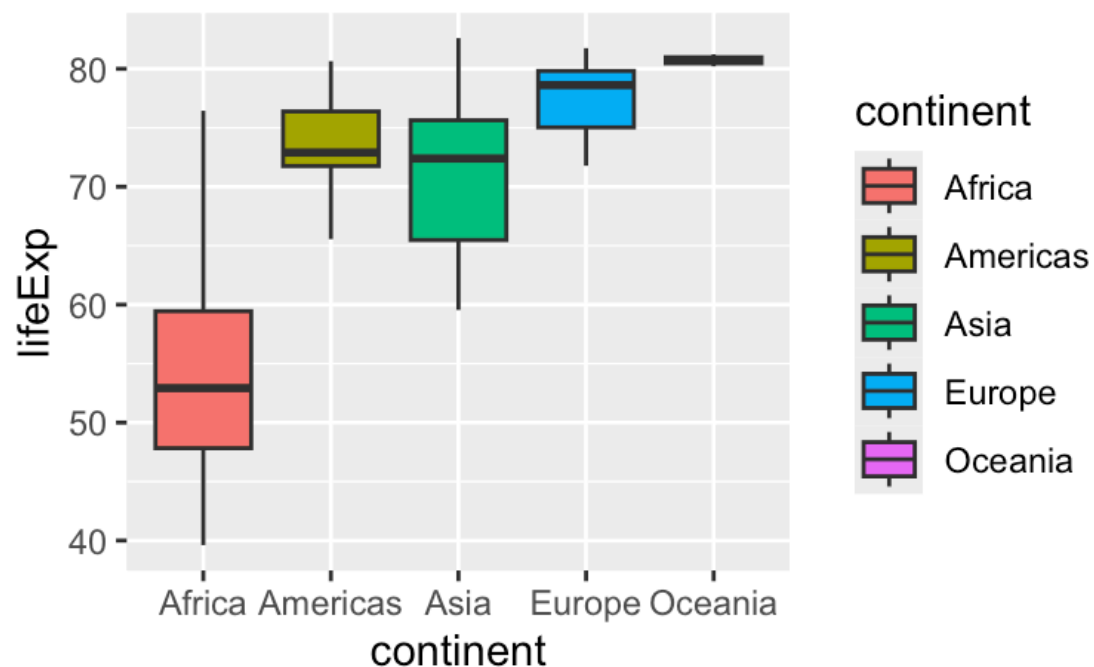
- Function: `filter()`
- Argument: `.data =`
- Arguments following: `year == 2007` What to do with the data
- Data (Object): `gapminder_2007`
- Assignment operator: `<-`
- Pipe operator: `|>`

Plot

```

1 library(dplyr)
2
3 gapminder_2007 <- gapminder |>
4   filter(year == 2007)
5
6 ggplot(data = gapminder_2007,
7        mapping = aes(x = continent,
8                      y = lifeExp,
9                      fill = continent)) +
10  geom_boxplot(outlier.shape = NA)

```



Our turn: SDG 6.2.1

Data

```
1 head(sanitation)
```

name	iso3	year	region_sdg	varname_short	varname_long	residence	percent
Afghanistan	AFG	2000	Central and Southern Asia	san_bas	basic sanitation services	national	21.9
Afghanistan	AFG	2000	Central and Southern Asia	san_bas	basic sanitation services	rural	19.3
Afghanistan	AFG	2000	Central and Southern Asia	san_bas	basic sanitation services	urban	30.9
Afghanistan	AFG	2000	Central and Southern Asia	san_lim	limited sanitation services	national	5.6
Afghanistan	AFG	2000	Central and Southern Asia	san_lim	limited sanitation services	rural	3.1
Afghanistan	AFG	2000	Central and Southern Asia	san_lim	limited sanitation services	urban	14.5

```
1 ncol(sanitation)
```

```
[1] 8
```

```
1 nrow(sanitation)
```

```
[1] 73710
```

Data

```
1 sanitation |>  
2   count(varname_short, varname_long)
```

varname_short	varname_long	n
san_bas	basic sanitation services	14742
san_lim	limited sanitation services	14742
san_od	no sanitation facilities	14742
san_sm	safely managed sanitation services	14742
san_unimp	unimproved sanitation facilities	14742

Our turn: md-03-exercises

1. Open posit.cloud/spaces/663318/content in your browser.
2. Verify that the ds4owd workspace is open.
3. Click Start next to md-03-exercises.
4. In the File Manager in the bottom right window, locate the 01-dplyr-our-turn.qmd file and click on it to open it in the top left window.

Your turn: md-03-exercises

1. Open posit.cloud/spaces/663318/content in your browser.
2. Verify that the ds4owd workspace is open.
3. Click Start next to md-03-exercises.
4. In the File Manager in the bottom right window, locate the 02-dplyr-your-turn.qmd file and click on it to open it in the top left window.

Take a break

Please get up and move! Let your emails rest in peace.



R Terminology

```
1 library(dplyr)
2
3 sanitation_national_2020_sm <- sanitation |>
4   filter(residence == "national",
5          year == 2020,
6          varname_short == "san_sm")
```

- Function: `filter()`
- Arguments following: `residence == "national", etc.` What to do with the data
- Data (Object): `sanitation_national_2020_sm`
- Assignment operator: `<-`
- Pipe operator: `|>`

Task 1.2

1. Use the `filter()` function to create a subset from the `sanitation` data containing urban and rural estimates for Nigeria.
2. Store the result as a new object in your environment with the name `sanitation_nigeria_urban_rural`

```
1 sanitation_nigeria_urban_rural <- sanitation |>  
2   filter(name == "Nigeria", residence != "national")
```

Task 1.3 - Connected scatterplot

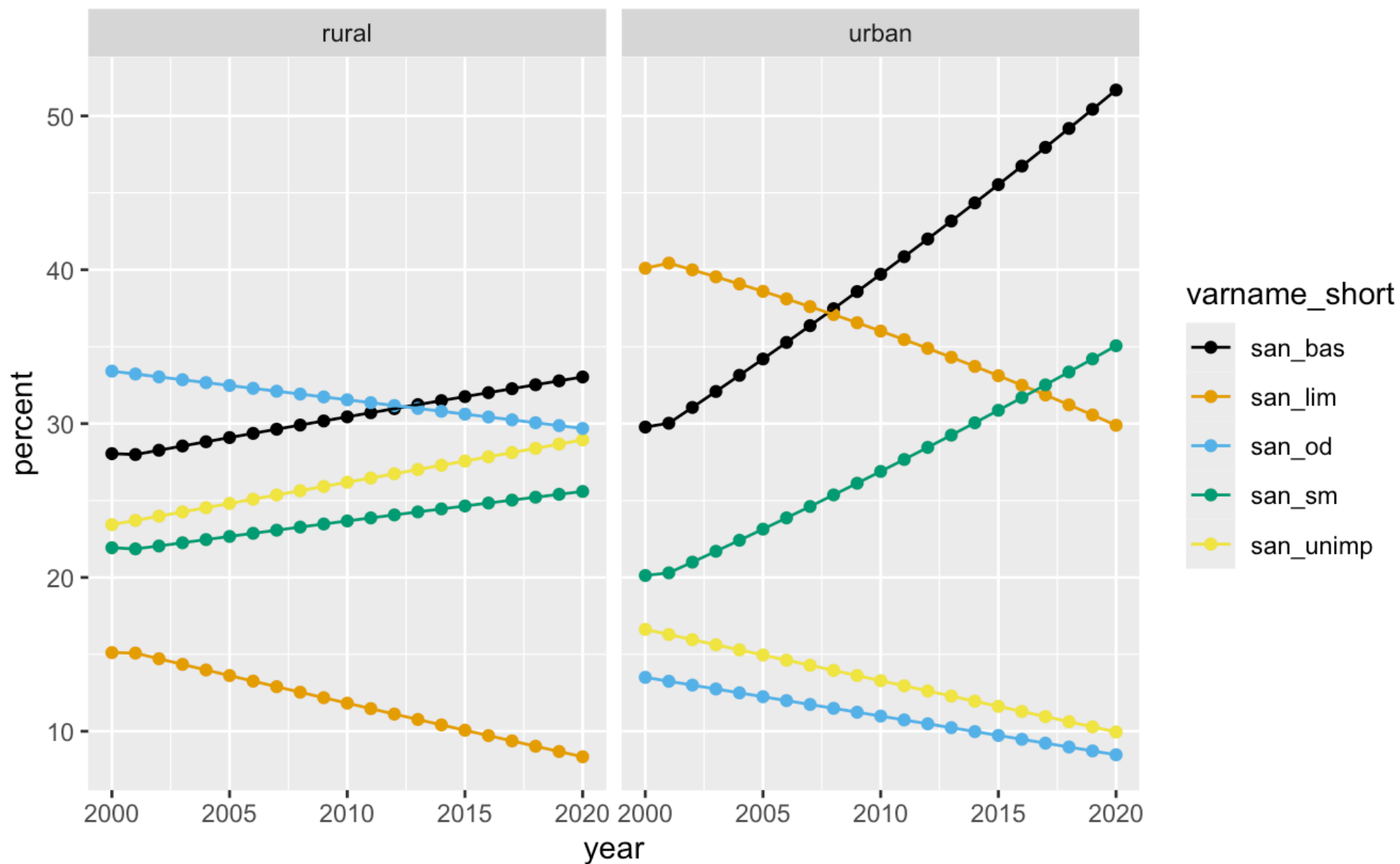
👍 Great for timeseries data 📅

1. Use the `ggplot()` function to create a connected scatterplot with `geom_point()` and `geom_line()` for the data you created in Task 1.2.
2. Use the `aes()` function to map the year variable to the x-axis, the `percent` variable to the y-axis, and the `varname_short` variable to color and group aesthetic.
3. Use `facet_wrap()` to create a separate plot urban and rural populations.
4. Change the colors using `scale_color_colorblind()`.

```
1 ggplot(data = sanitation_nigeria_urban_rural,  
2       mapping = aes(x = year,  
3                     y = percent,  
4                     group = varname_short,  
5                     color = varname_short)) +  
6   geom_point() +  
7   geom_line() +  
8   facet_wrap(~residence) +  
9   scale_color_colorblind()
```

📄 ds4owd-002.github.io/website/

Task 1.3 - Connected scatterplot



Our turn: back to 01-dplyr-our-turn.qmd

1. Open posit.cloud/spaces/663318/content in your browser.
2. Verify that the ds4owd workspace is open.
3. Click Start next to md-03-exercises.
4. In the File Manager in the bottom right window, locate the 01-dplyr-our-turn.qmd file and click on it to open it in the top left window.

Take a break

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Your turn: md-03-exercises

1. Open posit.cloud/spaces/663318/content in your browser.
2. Verify that the ds4owd workspace is open.
3. Click Start next to md-03-exercises.
4. In the File Manager in the bottom right window, locate the 03-dplyr-your-turn.qmd file and click on it to open it in the top left window.

Homework assignments module 3

Module 3 documentation

ds4owd-002.github.io/website/modules/md-03.html

Module 3

Data transformation with dplyr

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🎯 Learning Objectives

1. Learners can apply ten functions from the dplyr R Package to generate a subset of data for use in a table or plot.

🖥 Slides

[View slides in full screen](#) | [Download slides as PDF](#)

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Homework due date

- Homework assignment due: Monday, September 29th 2025
- Quiz due: Tuesday, October 8th 2025

Wrap-up

Thanks!

Slides created via revealjs and Quarto:

<https://quarto.org/docs/presentations/revealjs/>

Access slides as [PDF on GitHub](#)

